

SERVING PLAN 3 SERVING PLAN

Italian Wedding Soup

with Chicken Meatballs, Spinach, and Farro

Tonight's Italian wedding soup (or *minestra maritata*) honors the same harmonious “marriage” of meat and greens, with a few cheffy twists. We use tender spinach in place of bitter greens like escarole, and nutty, chewy farro rather than small pastas like orzo or ditalini. We add dried porcini mushrooms as an umami boost for the Parmesan-laced chicken meatballs, which are baked while the soup finishes simmering.

35–45 minutes 610 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 1 herb mix
  - ⅛ ounce dill
  - ⅛ ounce parsley
- 1 yellow onion
- 3 cloves garlic
- 1½ teaspoons porcini mushroom powder
- ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- ½ cup white wine
- 2 containers chicken stock
- ½ cup farro
- 3 tablespoons breadcrumbs
- 1 ounce grated Parmesan cheese
- 1 pound ground chicken
- 2 ounces baby spinach

You'll need

- olive oil
- 1 egg
- black pepper
- kosher salt
- 8" medium pot
- aluminum foil
- baking sheet

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Try rubbing 1 teaspoon olive oil between your hands before forming the meatballs, to help keep the chicken from sticking to your fingers.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking ground chicken to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse all produce. Roughly chop **dill** and **parsley** leaves, keeping herbs separate and discarding stems. Peel **onion**, halve, and cut **1 half** into small dice; save remainder for another use. Mince **garlic**.



2. Sauté aromatics

Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a medium pot over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **onion** and **garlic**. Sauté, stirring frequently, until softened and beginning to brown, 3–4 minutes. Add **porcini mushroom powder**, **crushed red pepper** (skip or use half for less heat), **white wine**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired, and cook until liquid is reduced by half, 1–2 minutes more.



3. Simmer soup

Add **chicken stock** and **farro** to pot with aromatics, then add enough **water** to cover farro by 1 inch. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce heat to medium high and simmer until flavors have melded and farro is mostly tender, 12–14 minutes. Your soup will reduce a bit during simmering—if the farro starts to peek out again, add enough water to just cover.



4. Mix and form meatballs

While soup simmers, line a baking sheet with aluminum foil, and set aside. In a large bowl, combine **breadcrumbs**, **parsley**, **half of Parmesan**, **1 egg**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired. Add **chicken** (see recipe tip). Using your hands, mix well, then form into 15 equal balls, about 1-inch thick. Arrange **meatballs** on prepared baking sheet, spacing apart as much as possible.



5. Bake meatballs

Bake **meatballs** until slightly browned and cooked through, 8–10 minutes. This is a great time to set the table.



6. Finish soup and plate

Once **meatballs** are cooked through, transfer to pot with soup and place over medium heat. Add **spinach** and **dill** and stir to wilt spinach, 2–3 minutes. Remove from heat. Taste and add **salt** and **black pepper** as desired, then divide **Italian wedding soup** among roomy serving bowls. Garnish with **remaining Parmesan** and dig in!

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